No.	Reference	Question	Answer
1	General	Would the Government consider it an OCI if a firm were to participate as a subcontractor on the IV&V effort, while separately serving as the prime contractor on the STARS III Business Transformation Support effort, assuming the roles remain clearly separated and the firm does not perform both transformation and IV&V functions on the same requirement.	**The government does not consider this an OCI.**
2	Attachment J.1	Attachment J1: CONTRACTOR PERFORMANCE SELF-ASSESSMENT document. Does this need to be sent to the CORs of the Past Performance contracts that we intent to include, and does it need to be submitted directly to the government by the CORs, or do we need to submit along with the 10 page past performance write-up?	**This attachment is provided for reference. It will be completed by the awardee after the first performance period.**
3	Attachment J.1	Can CPARS be submitted in lieu of the Self-Assessment template?	**See answer to Question 2**
4	General	Do we need to include all Reps and Certs, including the full FAR clause document from SAM.gov, or if our profile is active and current in SAM.gov, would a screenshot of that suffice along with an affirmation on active Reps and Certs.	**Confirmation of active SAM will suffice.**
5	General	Does the pricing information need to be submitted within the business volume as a PDF file? i.e. An excel file is not needed.	**PDF and excel are both acceptable formats**
6	General	Based on the available LCATs in our GSA STARS III schedule we will allocate the closest matching LCAT to the PWS Labor Category, which may be different from the items listed on Page 1 of the RFQ under "GSA Labor Category", confirming that this is okay, and the stated "GSA Labor Category" column is an example of the format.	**Confirmed, this is acceptable**
7	RFQ Section B.4	The labor categories in the Price Proposal Labor Rate Chart tables are already mapped with GSA labor categories. Since	**Contractors should propose labor categories from their GSA 8(A) STARS III contract.**

		the RFQ is released under GSA 8(A) STARS III, can you please consider updating the mapping with GSA 8(A) STARS III labor categories?	
8	RFQ SECTION I-CLAUSES	The first line states that "All terms and conditions of the awardee's GSA contract will be in effect for this task order". - Can you please confirm that GSA 8(A) STARS III contract meant here?	**Confirmed**
9	RFQ SECTION L	Last bullet states that "All quotes shall contain GSA Contract PRICING ONLY. Interested offerors must certify that the proposed items included in their GSA contract. Each item shall be clearly identified as GSA contract Pricing Items." - Can you please confirm that GSA 8(A) STARS III PRICING meant here?	**Confirmed, GSA 8(A) STARS III is a GSA vehicle.**
10	RFQ L.2.2 Pricing Instructions	"L.2.2 Pricing Instructions: Offeror are expected to make an independent assessment of the resources required to perform the tasks described in this solicitation. Offerors should use their own judgment based on their experience and approach to completion of this project to propose the price appropriate for the requirement." Based on this, vendor is allowed to provide its own mix of labor categories and hours. Please confirm.	**Offerors may propose a different labor mix provided the overall recommendations are in alignment with the Statement of Work (SOW).**
11	General	Is the goal to modernize the current systems or is the goal for Grant Solutions to be the primary (and potentially even the sole) system used for grant awards by HHS?	**The goal is to modernize the current solutions in alignment with the Statement of Work (SOW).**
12	General	Can the Government please provide information on the incumbent and contract value?	**This is a new requirement and, therefore, there is no incumbent.**
13	B.4	Pg. 1 - We assume that Offerors need to fill out the tables under B.4 CONSIDERATION AND PAYMENT SCHEDULE – TIME AND MATERIAL and submit with their proposal. If yes, should Offerors ONLY provide pages 1 and 2 and submit this with Volume II?	**The quote should include completed tables from B.4 inside a business quote (Volume II).**
14	Section L&M	Please confirm that Factor 2 Staffing Plan/Personnel Requirements is included in the 25-page Technical proposal with a	**Confirmed.**

		separate 10 pages for the Past Performance.	
15	Attachment J.1	Please confirm J.1 is not a pricing schedule of services; please confirm how offerors should use J.1.	**This has been updated to clarify J.1 refers to Contractor Performance Self-Assessment Template.**
16	Section L	Section L indicates there are 2 volumes: Technical and Cost/Price & Business. Please confirm the Technical Volume is comprised of (1) L.1.1 Transmittal and Cover Letter; (2) Technical Approach (Factor 1; L.1); (3) Staffing Plan/Personnel Requirements (Factor 2); and (4) Past Performance (Factor 3; L.2).	**Confirmed.**
17	L.2	On pg. 20, under L.2 Past Performance, what information is required in response to "Delivery Schedule – original AND final (or projected final, if the contract is active)"? Is this the Period of Performance?	**Yes.**
18	B.4	Can the Government please add the CAF line to the pricing chart (B.4) and the schedule of services attachment, if any?	**This has been added to the updated solicitation**
19	General	We request a one-week extension to allow industry to adjust to answers to questions.	**The solicitation will not be extended**
20	General	Section L does not have instructions for a staffing plan, yet Section M, Factor 2 is evaluating a staffing management plan. Please provide the Section L requirements for the Factor 2 point allocation.	**Section L.1.B has been updated to add a reference to the Staffing Plan.** **"The technical proposal shall consist of the offeror's proposal delineating its capabilities, staffing plan, and how it intends to perform the requirements."**
21	Page 19	Do we have to submit two volumes or three (as there is mentioned past performance volume)	**Two volumes. Past performance is considered a part of Volume I.**
22	Page 20	Total page limit for technical is 25 pages. However in past performance volume it is mentioned 10 for this does 25 pages include these 10 pages as well.	**The 10 pages for Past Performance are in addition to the 25 pages for Technical.**
23	General	Which labor categories need to be onsite performance and which labor categories need to be offsite.	**The government will not require any of the contractor's FTE (positions) to work onsite at DHHS Office of Grants Office at 200 Independence Avenue S.W.**

			Washington, D.C., 20201. However, at the COR's direction, contractor staff may be required to occasionally meet with the government onsite, at stated times. Therefore, onsite support will be occasional (primarily remote with limited onsite support).
24	General	Can we assign pm which will be onsite and other who will be offsite.	**See answer to question 23.**
25	Attachment J.1	Do we need to fill self-assessment form ourselves as mentioned and not by 3rd party please clarify.	**See answer to Question 2**
26	General	2 key personnel resumes need to be submitted? Please clarify	**Yes, please provide resumes for the proposed Program/Project Manager and Senior Technical Director.**
27	General	if applicable; justifications for noncompetitive proposed subcontracts; of technical data to be withheld; Please clarify what does this statement mean?	**Government is unable to locate this reference. Please review conflict of interest data in sections H and M.**
28	LABOR CATEGORY FTE CALCULATION	Can the Government confirm if the total annual hours are 2,400 for this labor category?	**The government used 1,920 annual hours per FTE to account for holidays, vacation, and sick leave.**
29	ODC PRICING STRUCTURE	Should ODC costs be included in the base/option year pricing tables or priced separately? Is there an anticipated ODC ceiling or estimated range the Government expects? Are ODC expenses billed at cost or with markup, and if markup is allowed, what percentage is acceptable?	**Offerors may not include ODCs in the pricing tables. If ODCs are needed, the government will exercise a separate task option and request pricing from the contractor, as approved by the COR.**
30	LABOR HOUR FLEXIBILITY	Is there a maximum percentage variance allowed between labor categories (e.g., +/- 20%)? Does this flexibility require CO approval or only COR notification? Are there restrictions on substituting senior-level hours for junior-level hours or vice versa?	**Offerors should select labor categories from their GSA schedule that best closely align with the responsibilities and qualifications for each role, ensuring compliance with all requirements specified in the Statement of Work (SOW).**

31	KEY PERSONNEL RESUMES	Since the Senior Technical Director is 1.25 FTE (2 positions), should we provide 2 resumes or 1 combined approach? Are resumes for other proposed staff required or only key personnel? Is there a resume page limit or format requirement?	**Resumes are required only for key personnel. Offerors are encouraged to keep resume length concise and tailored to the qualifications necessary to meet the requirements outlined in the Statement of Work (SOW).**
32	PROPOSAL VOLUME COUNT INCONSISTENCY	Should Past Performance be submitted as a separate third volume or incorporated within either the Technical or Business volume? If Past Performance is a separate volume, is the total proposal submission three volumes or should it be combined with another volume? How should volumes be labeled for submission (e.g., Volume I - Technical, Volume II - Past Performance, Volume III - Business)?	**See answers to questions 21 and 22**
33	AI-READINESS EVALUATION	Is AI-readiness a formal evaluation sub-factor or an area where additional points can be earned? Should AI approach be integrated throughout all five task areas or addressed separately? What specific AI capabilities or experience is the Government most interested in (e.g., generative AI, predictive analytics, MLOps)?	**Offerors are encouraged to integrate AI considerations throughout their technical approach. This may include demonstrating general AI awareness, leveraging emerging technologies, applying responsible AI principles, and identifying potential applications that support modernization objectives.**
34	PRICE-TECHNICAL CONSISTENCY REVIEW	Should the technical volume explicitly map proposed labor hours to specific SOW tasks? If we propose efficiencies that reduce total hours below the maximum, will this be viewed favorably or as insufficient effort?	**The pricing volume should clearly map proposed labor hours and categories to the corresponding Statement of Work tasks.** **While the technical volume should describe the approach and methodology, the detailed mapping of hours to tasks belongs in the pricing volume.** **The level of effort estimate provided by the Government is intended as a representative example.**

			Offerors are encouraged to perform their own independent analysis of the scope outlined in the Statement of Work and reflect this in their pricing volume.
35	SECURITY AND CLEARANCE REQUIREMENTS	Are security clearances required for any personnel (e.g., Secret, Public Trust)? Is a government background investigation required (e.g., NACI, Tier 1)? What is the timeline for personnel to obtain required clearances/investigations? Will personnel have access to PII, PHI, or other sensitive data requiring special handling?	**The anticipated clearances for this work are Tier 1 (low, non-sensitive) and Tier 2 (Moderate Risk Public Trust (MRPT) for these positions.** **The clearance process will begin post-award. Personnel may have access to FISMA Moderate data.**
36	INCUMBENT CONTRACTOR INFORMATION	Is there an incumbent contractor performing similar services? If so, will there be a transition period or knowledge transfer? Are incumbent personnel eligible to propose on this requirement?	**This is a new requirement and, therefore, there is no incumbent.**
37	DOGE MANDATE SPECIFICS	Are there specific DOGE cost-reduction targets beyond the 30% O&M reduction? Are there DOGE-mandated timelines or milestones this contract must support? What reporting requirements exist related to DOGE objectives?	**The Offeror may recommend cost reduction targets to the government in alignment with the requirements of the Statement of Work.**
38	Page 1	Government provides estimated level of effort (LOE) per LCAT to support this engagement. Will government accept proposals that deviate from the provided LOE estimation (e.g., FTEs)?	**Offerors may propose a different labor mix provided the overall recommendations are in alignment with the Statement of Work (SOW).**
39	Page 10	Telework "may be allowed" and "shall be billed as if working onsite." What is the expected onsite presence (days/week, per role)?	**The government will not require any contractor staff to work onsite at DHHS Office of Grants Office at 200 Independence Avenue S.W. Washington, D.C., 20201. However, at the COR's direction, contractor staff may be required to occasionally meet with the government onsite, at stated times. Therefore, onsite support will be occasional (primarily remote with limited onsite support).**

40	Page 1	Government provides an alignment of LCAT to GSA LCAT. Can government provide education/experience requirement against the provided LCATs? Will govenrment accept GSA STARS III rates aligned to these LCATs, assuming equivalent education/experience?	**Offerors are encouraged to perform their own independent analysis of the scope outlined in the Statement of Work and use their GSA rates that align with each role.** **Proposed labor categories should correspond to the Offeror's GSA schedule and demonstrate compliance with the requirements specified in the Statement of Work.**
41	General	This is a quick turnaround for a large proposal effort. If there is a delay in Q&A due to the holidays, it may impact the vendors ability to account for Q&A in their response. Will the government extend the due date beyond 1/6/26?	**The solicitation will not be extended**
42	B.4 Consideration and Payment Schedule – Time and Material, pg 1	The government listed the Senior Technical Director as 1.25 FTEs. Does the government require 2 key personnel resumes for this position? Will the government consider limiting this position to 1 FTE as 1.25 seems to heavily favor the incumbent.	**The Government requires resumes for key personnel positions.** **The level of effort estimate provided is for example purposes only.** **Offerors are encouraged to perform their own independent analysis of the scope outlined in the Statement of Work and structure their staffing plan accordingly.**
43	L.1 Technical Proposal Instructions Page 18	Will the government please provide page limits for Factor 2 Staffing Plan/Personnel Requirements.	**This is included in the 25-page limit for the technical volume.**
44	L.1 Technical Proposal Instructions	Will the government please provide instructions for Factor 2 Staffing Plan/Personnel Requirements.	**The Offeror should be able to fill this out without additional instructions.**

45	M.4 PRICE EVALUATION Pg 24	The proposal says "Proposed prices identified in the Schedule of Services and Attachment J.1 of the solicitation will be evaluated based on the values proposed for the base and all option years." But page 17 refers to Attachment J.1: Contractor Performance Self-Assessment Template. Is there a missing pricing spreadsheet that HHS needs to provide?	**This has been updated to clarify J.1 refers to Contractor Performance Self-Assessment Template**
46	FACTOR 1 – TECHNICAL APPROACH on page 24	The Proposal says: "Proposals shall separately address all five task areas outlined in Section C of the Statement of Work". There are 6 task areas in SOW, please confirm if we need to address C.2.6 Product Management, Oversight, and Business Operations Support.	**For clarity, this has been updated to "address all task areas outlined in Section C"**
47	C.2.1.6	What baseline(s) will the Government use to measure the 30% O&M cost reduction, and what methodology will validate savings?	**The government will use the legacy system O&M as the baseline. Contractors should propose a methodology to the government on how to best improve upon, quantify and validate savings.**
48	C.2.1.x	What are the expected deliverables for Current State Assessment tasks, and is there an available backlog or inventory	**The Government expects the Current State Assessment deliverable to include artifacts such as a comprehensive analysis of system architecture, operations, and technical debt, and will provide available documentation and inventories during the initial project start-up as needed to support this effort.**
49	E.2	What is the government's expectation for data resident in vendor's proprietary systems or tools supporting the deliverables (e.g., requirement development and maintenance)	**The Government expects that all deliverables and data supporting the Statement of Work (SOW) remain fully accessible to HHS, regardless of whether proprietary tools are used during development.** **Any data generated or maintained in vendor-owned systems must be provided to the Government in an open, non-proprietary format to ensure continuity,**

			transparency, and compliance with modernization and governance requirements.
50	L.2	Given the recency of the evolution of AI, for past performance, will the Government consider contracts that are similar in scope but smaller in size if they demonstrate innovation and measurable outcomes?	**Yes, the Government is likely to consider smaller contracts if they are similar in scope and clearly demonstrate innovation, measurable outcomes, and relevance to the SOW objectives.**
51	L	To what extent does the government intend to leverage Artificial Intelligence in their evaluation?	**The government expects that the Offeror will make recommendations to the use of Artificial Intelligence in response to the requirements of the Statement of Work (SOW).**
52	H.3	Does the government require certification of OCI mitigation with the proposal?	**Yes**
53	C.2.3.x	What is the current architectural state, what existing artifacts are available, and how is contractor decision authority distinguished from Government board oversight?	**Technical Architecture diagrams will be available to contractors after award.** **The contractor shall provide recommendations to which the government makes the final decisions.**
54	Section C.2.1 – Current State Assessment and Optimization	Is the scope of the current state assessment and subsequent transformation efforts limited to the three grants systems listed or is it encompassing of any adjacent systems, including the financial management systems?	**The scope of the current state assessment and subsequent transformation efforts includes the three grant systems listed and encompasses adjacent government systems, including financial management systems.**
55	Section H.1 – 352.237-75 Key Personnel	Does the Government have required qualifications and/or certifications for the two Key Personnel labor categories?	**The government requires that the offeror recommends the level of experience and qualifications of each key personnel in alignment with the requirements of the Statement of Work (SOW).**
56	Section L – Instructions, Conditions, and Notices to Offerors	The second bullet in Section L states that "a technical volume, business volume, and past performance information volume" is to be submitted. The third bullet in Section L (as well as Section L.1.A) states that	**This bullet point has been removed for clarity.** **Proposals shall consist of two volumes. Past performance is considered a part of Volume I.**

		"proposals shall consist of two (2) separate volumes: Volume I: Technical, Volume II: Cost/Price and Business." Further in Section L, the Volumes are titled something different – Section L.1.B.1 says "Volume I – Technical", Section L.2.b says "Past Performance Volume", and Section L.3 says "Volume II – Business Volume". All of these instructions are slightly different. Please clarify the specific Volumes required and their numbers (I, II, III) and titles.	
57	Section L.2.a – Past Performance Proposal Instructions	Please confirm that the Past Performance Volume is to be submitted as a separate Volume (and not included in the Technical Volume or Business Volume).	**See answers to questions 21 and 22**
58	Section L.2.2.b – Pricing Instructions	Section L.2.2.b states: "This volume consists of the actual offer to enter into a contract to perform the desired work. It also includes required representations, certifications, and acknowledgments, if applicable…" Please confirm that there are no required representations, certifications, or acknowledgments that need to be filled out or submitted.	**Confirmed**
59	Section L.2.2.b – Pricing Instructions	Section L.2.2.b states: "This volume consists of the actual offer to enter into a contract to perform the desired work. It also includes…justifications for noncompetitive proposed subcontracts…" What does the Government mean by "justifications for noncompetitive proposed subcontracts"? What exactly is the Government looking for as a response to this requirement?	**This point has been removed for clarity.**
60	Section L.2.2.d – Pricing Instructions	For the price proposal submission, does the Government only require the submission of RFQ Section B.4? Or should Offerors also provide a pricing Excel spreadsheet?	**A response to section B.4 should be incorporated into Business quote. Microsoft Word, Excel and PDF are all acceptable formats.**
61	Section M.3/Factor 1 –	Factor 1 (pg. 23) states that "proposals shall separately address all five task areas outlined in Section C of the Statement of	**For clarity, this has been updated to "address all task areas outlined in Section C"**

	Technical Approach	Work." There are six task areas outlined in the Statement of Work, not five. The Factor 1 description is missing C.2.6 – Product Management, Oversight, and Business Operations Support. Are Offerors required to address C.2.6?	
62	Section M.3/Factor 2 – Staffing Plan / Personnel Requirements	Section M.3 introduces a Staffing Plan that is not mentioned in Section L. Please confirm that Factor 2 – Staffing Plan/Personnel Requirements should be included in the 25 pages allowed for the Technical Volume.	**Staffing Plan/Personnel Requirements should be included in the 25 pages allowed for the Technical Volume.**
63	Section M.4 – Price Evaluation	Section M.4 states: "Proposed prices identified in the Schedule of Services and Attachment J.1 of the solicitation will be evaluated based on the values proposed for the base and all option years." By "Schedule of Services", does the Government mean RFQ Section B.4?	**This has been updated to clarify J.1 is reference to Contractor Performance Self-Assessment Template only.**
64	Section M.4 – Price Evaluation	Section M.4 states: "Proposed prices identified in the Schedule of Services and Attachment J.1 of the solicitation will be evaluated based on the values proposed for the base and all option years." Attachment J.1 is a post-award Contractor Performance Assessment. Was it mentioned in this sentence in error? Please clarify.	**This has been updated to clarify J.1 is reference to Contractor Performance Self-Assessment Template only.**
65	C.2.1.6	The SOW (C.2.1.6) mentions a goal of a 30% reduction in O&M costs. Does the government have a specific baseline for current O&M spending across the three systems, or will the contractor's first task be to establish that baseline?	**See question 47.**
66	C.1	C.1 refers to identifying 'duplication of capabilities.' Has the government already performed a preliminary audit of these redundancies, and can that be shared during the discovery phase?	**The government will share this information after award.**
67	General	Is there a preferred cloud service provider (AWS, Azure, GCP) or AI platform (FedRAMP-approved LLMs) for the OneGrants Cloud, or will the contractor need to conduct a full Alternatives Analysis?	**The government currently uses AWS Cloud Services.**

68	General	Given the AI focus, will the government provide a 'Sandbox' environment for the (C.2.3.5) Proof-of-Concepts (PoCs) that already meets HHS Zero Trust and security requirements?	**The Government will not furnish a pre-configured AI environment; contractors are expected to establish and maintain a compliant environment for AI-related activities in accordance with HHS security and Zero Trust requirements.**
69	Task 2.6.3	For the "rapid response team" mentioned in Task 2.6.3, what is the anticipated frequency and typical duration of these short-notice deployments?	**Short term notice deployments can occur anywhere from once per week to once a month.**
70	General	What specific reporting formats or audit protocols are expected for documenting alignment with Department of Government Efficiency (DOGE) mandates?	**The Offeror may recommend reporting formats or audit protocols that are aligned with the requirements of the Statement of Work.**
71	General	To what extent will the contractor be required to coordinate with other modernization vendors who are currently managing the underlying systems to ensure architectural alignment?	**As needed.**
73	General	For the "OneGrants Cloud" initiative, has a cloud service provider already been selected, or is the contractor expected to advise on the platform selection and migration strategy?	**The government currently utilizes AWS Cloud Services.**
74	General	Is there a specific technology currently in use for the "central document repository" in Task 2.6.2, or is the contractor expected to design and implement a new solution?	**The government utilizes SharePoint for records management.**
75	General	Aside from the Payment Management System (PMS), are there other internal HHS financial systems that require active API management or data reconciliation support?	**The legacy system currently supports 9 financial interfaces.**
76	General	Does the Department have a specific Zero Trust Architecture (ZTA) maturity model or technical roadmap that the contractor must follow?	**Contractors should assume alignment with HHS enterprise security policies, FISMA Moderate categorization, and Zero Trust implementation expectations as outlined in HHS IS2P and related governance frameworks.**

77	General	Can the Government clarify the specific security clearance levels required for Key Personnel? Will all contractor staff require a Public Trust background investigation prior to starting work, or is there a provisional "entry on duty" process?	**The anticipated clearances for this work are Tier 1 (low, non-sensitive) and Tier 2 (Moderate Risk Public Trust (MRPT) for these positions.** **The clearance process will begin post-award. Personnel may have access to FISMA Moderate data.**
78	General	Are there specific data residency requirements for the AI-powered data lake, particularly concerning the use of third-party Generative AI APIs?	**All data must remain within the Continental United States and comply with FedRAMP, FISMA Moderate, and HHS Zero Trust principles.**
79	General	Confirming the set-aside status: While the cover letter requires identifying company type (e.g., 8(a)), is this solicitation open to all GSA MAS holders regardless of socio-economic status?	**This is a GSA Stars III only requirement.**
80	M.5 ORGANIZATIONAL CONFLICT OF INTEREST	In recent days, the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services (HHS), Assistant Secretary for Financial Resources (ASFR), Office of Grants (OG), Division of Information Solutions (DIS) has released multiple solicitations, including **RFQ1789647 - Office of Grants' Business Transformation Support Objectives** on GSA 8(A) STARS III and **RFQ1789366 - Independent Verification and Validation (IV&V) Technical, Program, Financial & Risk Support** on GSA MAS 54151S. Both of these soliciations have complex OCI requirements. As such, we were wondering if it would be possible for one offeror to respond to both of these requirements, or would OCI prevent this?	**Offerors can respond to both.**
81	M.5 ORGANIZATIONAL CONFLICT OF INTEREST	What specific OCI concerns would vendors currently working on Grants.gov, Grant Solutions, or TAGG be subject to? For example: are current O&M/IT Development vendors (e.g. Guidehouse, Nava) eligible to respond to this solicitation?	**This solicitation is limited to GSA Stars III**
82	General	Would the vendor awarded this contract be conflicted out of performing the IT Development work for the recommended solution?	**No**

83	General	Does the Government have specific requirements (e.g., education, certifications) for the key personnel positions?	**See answer to question 40**
84	General	Given the significant personnel turnover (e.g., Reduction in Force) and retirements in federal agencies within the past year, the original Procuring Contracting Officer, Administrative Contracting Officer, and COR/COTR may no longer be within the same agency or employed by the federal government. Would the Government consider allowing alternative points of contact (e.g., program managers, project leads) or official contract documentation (e.g., CPARS ratings) to verify and validate past performance?	**Yes**
85	General	The solicitation requires fax numbers for each of the past performance points of contact. Given that fax machines are largely obsolete and many agencies no longer maintain fax lines, would the Government consider removing this requirement?	**This has been updated to remove fax number references.**
86	General	Do we need to address Task Area 6 - Product Management, Oversight, and Business Operations Support in the Technical Approach?	**Yes**
87	General	What is the page limit for the Staffing Plan/Personnel Requirements section in the Technical Approach?	**Staffing Plan/Personnel Requirements is to be included in the 25-page technical proposal.**
88	General	Can we use our Subcontractors Past Performances?	**Yes**
89	General	Is there any preference for this requirement?	**No**
90	General	What is the current budget for this project?	**This will not be provided**
91	General	Please confirm if the Agency wants the offeror to provide Actual or Sample resumes for Key personnel.	**Actual**
92	General	How will success be evaluated across Grants.gov, Grant Solutions, and TAGGS individually versus as an integrated ecosystem?	**Please refer to the RFQ.**

93	General	Are there known architectural or vendor constraints that limit modernization velocity?	**There are none that are known.**
94	General	Which operational processes consume the most O&M resources today?	**Operational resources consuming the most O&M resources include activities that require direct labor support.**
95	General	Which operational processes consume the most O&M resources today?	**See answer to question 94.**
96	General	How mature is the OneGrants Cloud today, and what capabilities are expected during this task order?	**The OneGrants Cloud initiative is in its early development phase and is intended to evolve into a secure, AI-enabled data platform that supports grants lifecycle modernization.** **During this task order, the expected activities are to support capabilities that include foundational cloud architecture, data ingestion and integration, and initial AI-driven analytics aligned with HHS Zero Trust and FISMA Moderate requirements.**
97	General	Are there preferred data standards, semantic models, or AI governance frameworks already in place?	**Yes, and the government is open to the vendor proposing additional standards.**
98	General	How does Division of Information Solutions (DIS) currently enforce CI/CD, testing, and acceptance standards?	**DIS currently enforces CI/CD, testing, and acceptance standards primarily through the HHS Enterprise Performance Life Cycle (EPLC) framework and related IT governance policies.**
99	General	How will adoption success be measured beyond system deployment?	**The Offeror shall recommend ways of measuring success beyond system deployment.**
100	General	What role does DIS expect the contractor to play in executive communications?	**The Offeror shall provide executive communications in alignment with the requirements in the Statement of Work (SOW)**

101	General	How will competing priorities across directorates be resolved?	**The Offeror shall provide solutions for resolution to the government in alignment with the requirements in the Statement of Work (SOW).**
102	General	Are the labor categories and FTE levels fixed, or does OG anticipate rebalancing over time?	**offerors may propose their own mix based on their technical approach and in alignment with the Statement of Work.**
103	General	Section B.4 identifies specific labor categories for pricing purposes. Please confirm whether all proposed labor categories must align exactly with labor categories awarded under the Offeror's GSA STARS III contract, or if Offerors may propose equivalent labor categories from their GSA contract that map to the required roles and responsibilities.	**All proposed labor categories must align exactly with labor categories awarded under the Offeror's GSA STARS III contract.**
104	General	**Grants.gov** • What is the current hosting model (cloud/on-prem/hybrid) and primary cloud service provider (if applicable)? • What are the major components/tech stack (e.g., front-end framework, application layer, integration/middleware, identity)? • What APIs/integration patterns are currently supported for external agency systems (REST/SOAP/eventing/batch)? • Are there known scalability or performance bottlenecks DIS wants the contractor to prioritize?	**Grants.gov is aJ2EE application deployed in AWS public cloud with Oracle backend with SOAP and REst API interfaces for S2S services with other federal systems. Grants.gov uses storyblok for powering front-end user experience.** **The Offeror may recommended prioritization based on similar projects.**
105	General	**Grant Solutions** • What is the current architecture pattern (monolithic vs modular/microservices) and hosting model? • Which integration points are considered "core" today (e.g., identity, financial systems, grants lifecycle services, reporting)? • Is there an established target-state architecture already (reference architecture, standards, preferred patterns), or is this expected to be developed under this task order?	**GrantSolutions is a Java based application using J2EE framework deployed in AWS public cloud. GrantSolutions is an API first application that uses oracle database and AWS terraform/Lambda scripts supporting interface automation scripts.** **The vendor may recommend a target-state architecture under this task order.**

106	General	**TAGGS** • What is the current data architecture (data warehouse vs lake/lakehouse) and primary technology stack? • What are the key upstream/downstream integrations (especially with PMS and other financial systems), and how are feeds reconciled today? • What are the main data quality/lineage challenges DIS wants addressed first?	**TAGGS/DATA PMO is a website developed in .Net with Oracle backend hosted in AWS cloud. TAGGS/DATA PMO uses AWS terraform/lambda scripts for automation of interfaces.** **The Offeror may provide examples of upstream/downstream integrations it has experience with, in alignment with the SOW.** **The Offeror may share examples of data quality/lineage challenges it has addressed in alignment with the SOW.**
107	General	**Simpler Grants.gov & Simpler Grants Management** • Are these separate programs with distinct product owners/roadmaps, or a unified program with shared governance? • What is the expected scope for "Simpler" (UX layer only vs end-to-end process + backend modernization)? • Are there specific standards/requirements already defined for modularity/open integration (e.g., preferred API standards, data standards, interoperability requirements)?	**Simpler Grants Management (SGM) builds upon the Simpler.Grants.gov project and is envisioned as a unified, cloud-native platform with shared governance under HHS Office of Grants, supporting the full federal grants lifecycle. The scope extends beyond UX improvements to include end-to-end process modernization, modular architecture, and backend integrations, ensuring scalability and interoperability. All services must align with open standards, API-first design, and the CommonGrants protocol for semantic data exchange, while meeting FedRAMP, Zero Trust, and FISMA Moderate security requirements.**
108	General	**"OneGrants Cloud" (AI-powered cloud data lake)** • Has a cloud platform/vendor already been selected? If yes, which services	**The Government currently utilizes AWS Cloud Services as the hosting platform for modernization initiatives, and OneGrants Cloud is expected to**

		are in use (storage, compute, catalog/governance, ML/AI)? • What is the intended operating model (central DIS platform team vs shared responsibility across vendors)? • What data domains are in-scope for initial ingestion (historical awards, applications, financial transactions, audits, etc.)? • Are there existing guardrails for responsible AI / trustworthy AI, model risk management, and privacy/security controls that we should align to?	**align with this environment for storage, compute, and security services. The operating model will be centrally managed by DIS with vendor collaboration for implementation, ensuring compliance with HHS governance and Zero Trust principles. Initial data ingestion will focus on historical grants data with all activities adhering to FedRAMP, FISMA Moderate, and HHS IS2P policies.**
109	General	**Security, Compliance, and Governance** • What are the applicable security/compliance requirements for these platforms (e.g., FedRAMP authorization level, FISMA system categorization, Zero Trust implementation expectations)? • Is there an existing enterprise architecture governance process (e.g., EPLC checkpoints, architecture review board) and artifacts we should assume (reference architectures, standards, target operating model)?	**FISMA Moderate** **Yes, there is an existing enterprise architecture governance process.**
110	General	Will the contractor be granted access to current-state architecture documentation, code repositories, CI/CD pipelines, and operational telemetry (logs/APM) for assessment activities?	**Yes.**
111	General	Are there constraints we should account for (e.g., incumbent tools, mandated platforms, contract/vendor boundaries, data residency)?	**There are none that are known.**